

Zomboid Server Admin

Quick Start Guide

Version 1.1.0

You've been given admin access to the Project Zomboid dedicated server. This guide covers everything you need to check on the server, manage players, and tweak game settings like zombie spawn rate.

Keep this guide handy - you don't need to memorize any of it.

1. Logging In

Your admin access is a separate account on the server, just for game administration. It cannot do anything outside of managing the Zomboid server itself.

```
ssh zomboid-admin@192.168.1.221
```

Your password will be given to you separately by whoever set up your access - don't share it with anyone else. If you're asked for a password when connecting, that's normal; type it in (it won't show on screen as you type) and press Enter.

If you're on Windows, any terminal works (PowerShell, Command Prompt, or Windows Terminal). On Mac or Linux, use the Terminal app.

2. Running Commands

Once you're logged in, every command below is run like this:

```
/opt/zomboid/hermes-zomboid-admin-local.sh <command>
```

For example, to check whether the server is healthy:

```
/opt/zomboid/hermes-zomboid-admin-local.sh status
```

3. Checking the Server

status

Full health check: is it running, how many players, disk space, recent errors.

players

Who is connected right now.

logins

Every account that has ever existed, and when they last connected.

auditlog

The last 20 kicks/bans, and who issued them.

4. Controlling the Server

start

Turn the server on.

stop

Turn the server off (saves the world first).

restart

Turn it off and back on again.

update

Install the latest Zomboid server files from Steam, then restart.

Heads up: start, stop, restart, and update all disconnect anyone currently playing. Use "broadcast" (below) to warn people a minute or two beforehand if you can.

5. Starting a Brand New World

newworld --confirm

Wipes the current map completely - every building, item, and zombie - and starts a fresh world with a new random layout. Nobody's character or progress on the current map survives this. It also disconnects anyone currently playing, the same as restart.

What IS kept: the whitelist, everyone's access level, and the ban list - accounts and permissions carry over into the new world untouched. The old map isn't deleted either; your admin can dig it back out if needed.

STOP AND THINK before using this one. It's the single most destructive command in this guide - the whole map is gone for everyone, immediately. Don't run it on your own; talk to your admin and make sure everyone playing agrees first. The --confirm at the end is a safety check, not optional decoration - the command refuses to run without it.

6. Managing Players

adduser <name> [password]

Add someone to the whitelist so they're allowed to join. Password is optional.

removeuser <name>

Remove someone from the whitelist.

setaccesslevel <name> <level>

Change someone's permissions. Levels, low to high: user, priority, observer, gm, moderator, admin. Use "admin" to make someone else an admin too.

setpassword <name> <newpass>

Reset a player's in-game password.

kick <name> [reason]

Boot someone off right now - they can rejoin immediately.

banuser <name> [reason]

Ban someone so they can't rejoin.

unbanuser <name>

Lift a ban.

Names go exactly as they appear in "logins" or "players" above - not their Steam name, their in-game account name.

7. Changing Game Settings (Spawn Rate, Loot, etc.)

sandboxvars

See every current game setting.

sandboxvars <name>

See just one setting, e.g. sandboxvars PopulationMultiplier

sandboxvar <name>=<value>

Change a setting.

A couple of the more useful ones for zombie spawn rate:

```
sandboxvar PopulationMultiplier=1.2
```

```
sandboxvar RespawnHours=24
```

(higher PopulationMultiplier = more zombies; RespawnHours controls whether cleared areas repopulate over time)

Heads up: Changing a game setting always restarts the server to apply it - same as "restart" above. It also automatically backs up the settings file first, so if a change turns out to be a bad idea, ask your admin to help you roll it back.

8. Talking to Players

broadcast "message"

Send a message to everyone currently on the server.

save

Save the game world right now, without restarting.

9. Good to Know

- Only change settings you actually understand - if you're not sure what something does, ask before trying it.
- Every action here is real and immediate - there's no "undo" button, though world saves and settings backups give you some safety net.
- If something looks broken or a command doesn't do what you expected, stop and ask your admin rather than trying more commands to fix it.